

D661

Creating Positive Learning Environments

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In October, a third-grade class still takes eight minutes to line up for lunch. The teacher posted the lining-up rules in September. The hallway was recently repainted, and the lunchroom serves pizza on Fridays. What should the teacher do?

- A. Take away recess until they line up faster.
- B. Line up only on Fridays, when students are most motivated.
- C. Post the rules in a larger font.
- D. Reteach the routine: model it, have students practice it, and give specific praise when they do it well.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

2.

A teacher is setting class norms in the first week of school. The room has flexible seating and a class pet fish. Which approach is most likely to build ownership?

- A. Skip norms, since good students already know how to behave.
- B. Lead a discussion where students help write 3-5 positively stated norms, such as “We listen when others speak.”
- C. Make a rule for the fish tank first.
- D. Post a list of 15 rules starting with “Do not.”

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

3.

An instructional coach tallies one 30-minute math lesson: the teacher made 24 corrective statements and 6 specific positive statements. The class meets right after lunch. To reach a 4-to-1 positive-to-corrective ratio while keeping 6 corrections, how many specific positive statements would be needed?

- A. 96
- B. 6
- C. 24
- D. 2

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
-----------------------------	---	-----------------------	---

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher gives about 20 specific positive statements in a lesson. To stay at or above a 4-to-1 ratio, what is the most corrections she should make?

- A.** 80
- B.** 0, because any correction lowers the ratio.
- C.** 5
- D.** 16

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Every day when independent writing starts, a student tears his paper and is sent to the office, where he spends the rest of the period. He is tall for his age and likes basketball. What is the most likely function of the behavior?

- A.** To seek adult attention from the teacher.
- B.** To get peer attention.
- C.** To show off his height and athletic skill.
- D.** To escape the writing task, which the office referral gives him.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's disruptions are maintained by escape from hard reading tasks. Which response would best meet the need without rewarding the behavior?

- A.** Teach the student to request a short break card and break the task into smaller parts.
- B.** Send the student to the hallway whenever he disrupts.
- C.** Double the reading assignment as a consequence.
- D.** Ignore the disruptions completely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

During a class discussion, a usually engaged student whispers to a neighbor for the first time this week. The class is discussing a chapter book, and a visitor from the district is at the back of the room. What is the best first response?

- A. Stop the class and name the student publicly.
- B. Move closer to the student or give a quiet nonverbal cue while continuing to teach.
- C. Correct more firmly than usual because the visitor is watching.
- D. Write an office referral.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student has ignored two quiet reminders and a proximity cue, and is now repeatedly disrupting others' work. What is the appropriate next level of response?

- A. A brief private conversation that states the expectation and a clear, known consequence.
- B. Another nonverbal look.
- C. Immediate suspension request.
- D. Call the student out in front of the class.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student suddenly shoves his desk, puts his head down, and refuses to speak after a loud fire drill. He transferred in two weeks ago and plays the trumpet. The teacher knows little about his past. What is the best first step?

- A. Tell him firmly to sit up and apologize now.
- B. Ask him to show his trumpet skills to lift his mood.
- C. Assign a consequence right away so all students see fairness.
- D. Speak calmly, offer a quiet space or a moment to settle, and talk about what happened later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

During a group project, one student mocked a classmate's drawing, and the classmate cried. The project was on local birds, and it was the last period of the day. Which response best reflects restorative practice?

- A. Give the student who mocked a detention and move on.
- B. Meet with both students, ask what happened and who was affected, and have the student who mocked help decide how to make it right.
- C. Let it go, since restorative practice means no consequences.
- D. Wait until tomorrow because it is the last period.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher asks a student, "What happened? Who was affected? What do you need to do to make things right?" Which approach is the teacher using?

- A. A token economy
- B. Planned ignoring
- C. A restorative conversation
- D. Exclusionary discipline

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

In a hybrid seventh-grade class, several online students rarely speak. The school's video platform was updated last month, and the teacher's room has a large window. Which step best builds community for the online students?

- A. Set shared online norms, start with a quick check-in, and let students join through chat, polls, or small breakout groups.
- B. Focus teaching on in-room students, since online students can watch.
- C. Require every camera to be on at all times.
- D. Wait for the next platform update to fix engagement.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

In October, a third-grade class still takes eight minutes to line up for lunch. The teacher posted the lining-up rules in September. ~~The hallway was recently repainted, and the lunchroom serves pizza on Fridays.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: fix a failing routine **Decides:** Routines must be taught and practiced, not just posted.

A	Adjacent category	Punishment does not teach the procedure.
B	Camouflage	Reacts to the pizza detail, not to the routine problem.
C	Dropped element	Posting without teaching and practice is what already failed.
D	Correct	Explicit teaching and practice make routines stick.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A teacher is setting class norms in the first week of school. ~~The room has flexible seating and a class pet fish.~~ Which approach is most likely to build ownership?

Target word: effective norm setting **Decides:** Few, positive, built with students.

A	Absolute language	Expectations must be taught to everyone.
B	Correct	Co-created, positive, and brief.
C	Camouflage	The pet is not the priority in setting class norms.
D	Inverted operation	Long, negative, teacher-only rules reduce clarity and ownership.

3. Answer C Concept 3

An instructional coach tallies one 30-minute math lesson: the teacher made 24 corrective statements and 6 specific positive statements. ~~The class meets right after lunch.~~ To reach a 4-to-1 positive-to-corrective ratio while keeping 6 corrections, how many specific positive statements would be needed?

Target word: positives needed for 4:1 **Decides:** 4×6 corrections = 24 positives.

A	Wrong stem number	Multiplies 4 by the current 24 corrections instead of the target 6.
B	Wrong stem number	The current positive count, not the target.
C	Correct	4 positives for each of 6 corrections = 24.
D	Inverted operation	Divides instead of multiplying.

4. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

A teacher gives about 20 specific positive statements in a lesson. To stay at or above a 4-to-1 ratio, what is the most corrections she should make?

Target word: solve for corrections **Decides:** $20 / 4 = 5$.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
B	Absolute language	Corrections are expected; the ratio sets their proportion.
C	Correct	$20 \text{ positives} / 4 = 5 \text{ corrections}$.
D	Adjacent category	Subtracts 4 instead of applying the ratio.

5. Answer D Concept 4

Every day when independent writing starts, a student tears his paper and is sent to the office, where he spends the rest of the period. ~~He is tall for his age and likes basketball.~~ What is the most likely function of the behavior?

Target word: function of the behavior **Decides:** Behavior occurs at writing time and ends with leaving writing.

A	Confusion set	He leaves the teacher; the task is what disappears.
B	Adjacent category	Possible in general, but the pattern points to avoiding writing.
C	Camouflage	Personal traits do not explain when the behavior happens.
D	Correct	The consequence removes the task, reinforcing the behavior.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A student's disruptions are maintained by escape from hard reading tasks. Which response would best meet the need without rewarding the behavior?

Target word: reverse: choose the response from the function **Decides:** Teach an appropriate way to get a break and support the task.

A	Correct	Replaces the behavior with an acceptable way to meet the need while keeping the task.
B	Inverted operation	Removal gives the escape the behavior seeks.
C	Absolute language	Adds pressure without teaching a replacement skill.
D	Confusion set	Planned ignoring fits attention-seeking, not escape.

7. Answer B Concept 5

During a class discussion, a usually engaged student whispers to a neighbor for the first time this week. The class is discussing a chapter book, ~~and a visitor from the district is at the back of the room.~~ What is the best first response?

Target word: least-intrusive correction **Decides:** Minor, first-time behavior.

A	Inverted operation	Public correction escalates a minor issue.
B	Correct	Proximity or a look is the least intrusive effective step.
C	Camouflage	The observer does not change what the behavior calls for.
D	Adjacent category	Formal consequences are for serious or repeated behavior.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A student has ignored two quiet reminders and a proximity cue, and is now repeatedly disrupting others' work. What is the appropriate next level of response?

Target word: reverse: when to step up the response **Decides:** Least-intrusive steps have already been tried.

A	Correct	Escalate one step at a time, still privately, after low-level cues fail.
B	Dropped element	Repeats a step that has already failed.
C	Absolute language	Jumps several levels past what the behavior warrants.
D	Adjacent category	Public shaming damages relationships and escalates.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A student suddenly shoves his desk, puts his head down, and refuses to speak after a loud fire drill. ~~He transferred in two weeks ago and plays the trumpet.~~ The teacher knows little about his past. What is the best first step?

Target word: trauma-informed first response **Decides:** The student is dysregulated; safety and calm come first.

A	Inverted operation	Demands compliance while the student is flooded.
B	Camouflage	Uses an unrelated detail and adds pressure.
C	Absolute language	Consequences can follow later; immediate ones escalate.
D	Correct	Regulation comes before reasoning or consequences.

10. Answer B Concept 7

During a group project, one student mocked a classmate's drawing, and the classmate cried. ~~The project was on local birds, and it was the last period of the day.~~ Which response best reflects restorative practice?

Target word: restorative response **Decides:** Focus on harm and repair, with the student involved.

A	Adjacent category	Punishment alone does not repair the harm.
B	Correct	Restorative questions and repair by the person who caused harm.
C	Confusion set	Restorative practice includes accountability through repair.
D	Camouflage	Timing of the class does not decide the approach.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A teacher asks a student, "What happened? Who was affected? What do you need to do to make things right?" Which approach is the teacher using?

Target word: reverse: identify the approach from its questions **Decides:** Questions focus on harm and repair.

A	Adjacent category	A reward system, not a repair process.
B	Confusion set	A strategy for attention-seeking behavior.
C	Correct	These are standard restorative questions.
D	Inverted operation	Exclusion removes the student instead of repairing harm.

12. Answer A Concept 8

In a hybrid seventh-grade class, several online students rarely speak. ~~The school's video platform was updated last month, and the teacher's room has a large window.~~ Which step best builds community for the online students?

Target word: online community building **Decides:** Clear norms and several ways to participate.

A	Correct	Multiple participation paths and intentional connection.
B	Dropped element	Leaves online students out of the community.
C	Absolute language	Cameras on does not equal engagement and can create barriers.
D	Camouflage	The tool update does not build relationships.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Teach routines explicitly	Procedures are taught like content: explain, model, practice, and reinforce, then reteach when they slip.	Posting rules once and expecting students to follow them.	Transitions or daily tasks that keep breaking down.
2	Positive, co-created norms	A few norms stated positively and built with students increase ownership and clarity.	A long list of “don’ts” written by the teacher alone.	The start of the year or a reset of class expectations.
3	Positive-to-corrective ratio	Aim for about four specific positive interactions for every correction.	Only noticing students when they misbehave.	Counts of praise vs. corrections.
4	Function of behavior	Behavior serves a purpose (usually to get or avoid something); a response should meet the need without rewarding the behavior.	Using a consequence that gives the student what the behavior was seeking, such as sending out a student who wanted to escape.	A pattern of when behavior happens and what follows.
5	Least-intrusive, private correction	Start with the least intrusive response—proximity, a look, a quiet private reminder—before public or formal consequences.	Calling out a student in front of the class for a minor issue.	A minor, first-time disruption.
6	Trauma-informed practice	Help a dysregulated student feel safe and calm first; reasoning and consequences come after regulation.	Lecturing or demanding compliance while the student is flooded.	A student who shuts down or escalates suddenly.
7	Restorative practices	Focus on who was harmed and how to repair it, with the student taking part in making it right.	Equating restorative practice with no consequences or with punishment alone.	Harm to a peer or the class community.
8	Community in online and hybrid classes	Online belonging is built on purpose with clear norms, regular check-ins, and multiple ways to participate.	Assuming camera-on requirements equal engagement.	A virtual class with quiet or disconnected students.

Course scope (public description): Creating Positive Learning Environments delves into the key elements that contribute to creating and maintaining a positive learning atmosphere for educators focused on fostering supportive and productive classroom climates. The course teaches effective communication, classroom norms and routines, and positive behavior supports. Emphasizing the importance of a safe and inclusive environment, the course also explores methods to promote student engagement, collaboration, and mutual respect among all learners. It also addresses the role of mental well-being in learning, exploring trauma-informed and restorative practices, which are addressed in relation to online and hybrid learning environments. Through a blend of theoretical frameworks and practical applications including case studies, Creating Positive Learning Environments teaches learners how to develop and sustain environments that not only enhance academic performance but also support the holistic development of students.